

Jiamin Cheng
jiamincheng@nyu.edu
jiamin.bio
10 Washington Pl, New York

Education

- 2026– **PhD** in Linguistics, New York University
- 2024–25 **MSt** in Linguistics, Philology and Phonetics, University of Oxford
- Semantics module essay: *Unpack "Must": Deviations in the Inferential Structure*
(Supervisor: Prof. Daniel Altshuler)
- Psycholinguistics module research proposal: *Individual Representation in Plurals: A Case in Mandarin Garden-path Sentences* (Supervisor: Dr. Jana Willer Gold)
- 2020–24 **BA** (Honors) in Philosophy, Minor in Cinematic Arts, University of Southern California
- Thesis: *Dual Functions of Verbal -le in Mandarin: Progressive Aspect Marker and Continuity Operator* (Supervisor: Prof. Barry Schein)

Publications

Hilary S.Z. Wynne, Jiamin Cheng & Henry Emery. *Eliciting language-specific signatures for ESPs in the human brain: An exploratory EEG study on Aviation English*. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=6512396> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.6512396>. (under review).

Hilary S.Z. Wynne, Jiamin Cheng & Henry Emery. *How the brain processes Aviation English: Crafting a neurolinguistic perspective on the effects of nonstandard phraseology*. Proceedings of the International Civil Aviation English Association (2025) Conference. (forthcoming).

Conference Presentations

Talks

Hilary Wynne & Jiamin Cheng. *Evidence for the interaction of global and local knowledge in expectation in the domain-restricted language of aviation* Discourse Expectations: Theoretical, Experimental and Computational Perspectives (DETEC 2026) (Utrecht, Netherlands). Sept. 2026.

Jiamin Cheng & Isabella Fritz. *Derivational morphology in word production: A novel experimental paradigm* 2026 Oxford Postgraduate Conference in Linguistics (Oxford, UK). June 2026.

Jana Willer-Gold, Bojana Ristic, Mfundo Didi, Jiamin Cheng & Jochen Zeller. *Individuation as a processing cue in Zulu* DGfS 2026 Workshop: Finding Patterns Through Fieldwork in African Languages (Trier, Germany). Feb. 2026.

Jiamin Cheng. *Plurality: A matter of individuation, not just number* Edinburgh Linguistics and English Language Postgraduate Conference 2025 (Edinburgh, UK). June 2025.

Posters

Hilary Wynne, Jiamin Cheng, E. Matthew Husband & Henry Emery. *Negotiating global and domain-specific prediction in sentence processing: Neural evidence from aviation* Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) (Saarbrücken, Germany). Sept. 2026.

Qianhui Ni, Bella Fascendini, Lisa Miao, Jiamin Cheng & Henrike Moll. *Beyond words: Revealing toddlers' understanding of mental states through expressions* Cognitive Development Society (CDS) 2024 Bi-Ennial Conference (Pasadena, CA, USA). Mar. 2024.

Talks

Vowels and Consonants in Mandarin Chinese Pronunciation Teaching Workshop (Exeter College, Oxford, UK). Apr. 2026.

Plurality: A Matter of Individuation, Not Just Number Oxford Syn/Sem Workshop (Oxford, UK). May 2025.

Research Experience

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| 2025–26 | Research Assistant (Neurolinguistics) , Language & Brain Laboratory , University of Oxford (PIs: Prof. Aditi Lahiri , Dr. Hilary Wynne , Dr. Isabella Fritz)
- Projects: i) Neurolinguistic investigation of expectation in aviation English; ii) Production planning process of words in German and English speakers. |
| 2024–25 | Research Assistant (Psycholinguistics) , University of Oxford (PI: Dr. Jana Willer-Gold)
- Project: Individuation as a processing cue in Zulu |
| 2022–24 | Undergraduate Research Assistant (Psycholinguistics) , PoMMLab , USC (PI: Prof. Zuzanna Fuchs)
- Projects: i) The influence of natural acquisition of the target language on the increased listening efforts of Spanish speakers; ii) Processing of pre-nominal cue (the article) containing a semantic feature and abstract noun category feature. |
| 2022–24 | Undergraduate Research Assistant (Developmental Psychology) , MID.LA , USC (PI: Prof. Henrike Moll)
- Projects: i) The role of witnessing others' experiences in toddlers' mental state ascription; ii) Toddlers' violated expectation ascriptions to the agents. |
| 2023 | Undergraduate Research Assistant (Communication) , Annenberg Inclusion Initiatives , USC
- Topic: Studying diversity and inclusion in the entertainment industry. |

Awards & Honors

2026	NYU GSAS MacCracken 5-year fellowship
2025	LPP Faculty Travel Grant, University of Oxford (£500; <i>travel grant for postgraduate students</i>)
2025	Wolson College Travel Grant, University of Oxford (£300; <i>travel grant for postgraduate students</i>)
2024	SOAR Award, USC (\$500; <i>research grant for undergraduate students</i>)
2023	SURF Award–Dean Howard Gillman Fund, USC (\$3,000; <i>summer undergraduate research grant</i>)
2023	Renaissance Scholar, USC (<i>recognizes undergraduates excelling in two distinct fields of study</i>)
2023	Academic Achievement Award, USC (<i>tuition benefit</i>)
2020–24	Dean’s List, USC

Academic Service

2026 Apr	Co-organizer , Pronunciation Teaching Workshop, Exeter College, Oxford, UK
2024–2025	Committee Member , 2025 Oxford Postgraduate Conference in Linguistics , Oxford, UK

Tools & Skills

Tools

Microsoft Office Suite, Google Suite
Pro Tools, Premiere, Avid

Lab Skills

Methodologies: EEG data collection and analysis; eye-tracking data collection; behavioral studies (e.g., self-paced reading, judgment tasks).

Software and Programming: Ibex Farm, Matlab, L^AT_EX, R, PsychoPy, Python, JMP, Praat, Qualtrics

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (Native), Shanghai Chinese (Native), Ningbo Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Beginner)

Last updated: September 30, 2026